52. The ITCZ is responsible for the seasonal character of precipitation in South America's extensive tropical wet-dry climatic zone. The trade winds of both hemispheres converge between the subtropical anticyclones of the Northern and Southern hemispheres in that low-pressure region. A migrating zone of unstable atmospheric conditions results, bringing periods of prolonged, abundant precipitation.
    During El-Nino event, rain fall along western coast of South America.
53. Among the tropical climates, the tropical rainy, or rainforest, type occurs on the Pacific coast of Colombia, in the Amazon basin, on the coast of the Guianas, and on part of the coast of Brazil. The average daily temperature is about 86 °F (30 °C), with monthly and annual variations of less than about 5 °F (3 °C). Heavy rainfall, well-distributed throughout the year, averages about 100 inches (2500 mm) annually in Belem (Brazil), about 110 inches (2800 mm) in Iquitos (Peru), and 70 inches (1800 mm) in Manaus (Brazil). The Choco region of Colombia-one of the wettest areas in the world receives in excess of 400 inches (10,200 mm), and it rains more than 300 days per year. In the Amazon region, rains do not fall evenly over the basin. The southern part receives most of its rainfall during the Southern Hemisphere summer (October to April), while the northern part has its rainy season during the Northern Hemisphere summer (May to September). The "dry" season is neither lengthy nor noticeable; humidity is always high.
54. Warm and cold deserts and certain coastal and interior regions are classified as arid climates. Patagonia and northwestern Argentina constitute the largest of the interior arid regions. Rainfall is low, only about 4 inches (100 mm) in San Juan in the north and about 7 inches (180 mm) farther south in Neuquen. The annual range in average monthly temperatures in Patagonia-the greatest in South America-is more than 36°F (20°C), the result of warm summers and cold winters. The Atacama Desert, a narrow strip along the Pacific coast between latitudes 5° and 31°S, is a coastal desert. The cold seas associated with the Peru Current and the proximity of the high Andes produce an inversion of normal atmospheric temperatures, as air in contact with the water cools